

Teacher Guide & Answer Key

60 SECONDS TO READY

01 ANSWER KEY

QUICK REFERENCE

VOCABULARY

1 – D 2 – A 3 – E 4 – B
5 – C

TRUE OR FALSE

1 T 2 F 3 T 4 F 5 F

LANGUAGE IN CONTEXT

1 trade-off 2 bear the brunt of
3 a victim of its own success 4 reconcile
5 hollowed out

TRUE OR FALSE · EVIDENCE

1 the economy “leans heavily on the very people being soaked” · 2 “numbers alone explain surprisingly little” · 3 a “small charge is unlikely to deter” · 4 it “may simply spread the damage” · 5 whether it works “is far from clear”

CRITICAL THINKING · YOU ARE THE COUNCIL

No correct package — the assumption column is the lesson. Strong answers name what would prove an assumption wrong: tax revenue lost in general budgets, cruise passengers switching to budget flights, a hotel ban that fuels short-term rentals. “Change nothing” is a decision too: it assumes a neighborhood can lose its residents without losing itself.

02 TEACHER GUIDE

BEFORE CLASS

AIM

Evaluate responses to overtourism, expose their assumptions, and defend a position under challenge.

LENGTH

60–75 minutes.

TIP

Don't accept “it depends.” Ask: on what, and which way does it tip? Opposing groups attack the policy, not the presenters.

EXTENSION

Rewrite the last paragraph as a hotel owner. What changes, and what is left out?

03 DISCUSSION NOTES

GUIDE THE TALK

STUDENTS MAY MENTION

who profits vs. who pays · housing & short-term rentals · fees as class filters · displacement · “authenticity” · whether dispersal just moves the problem

FOLLOW-UP QUESTIONS

- Is a fee that only the wealthy can ignore fair, or just efficient?
- Does your own travel contribute to the problem you are criticizing?
- Who is missing from the argument: workers, future residents, the visitors themselves?

ENCOURAGE THIS LANGUAGE

“That rests on the assumption that...” · “I'd concede that..., but...” · “The flaw in that argument is...”

04 MODEL WRITING

SAMPLE ANSWER

It is tempting to call the measures cities use against overtourism heavy-handed. Entry fees, caps, and rental bans can price out ordinary travelers and, as critics rightly point out, turn historic centers into ticketed museums. That objection has real force: a city only the wealthy can visit has not solved its problem so much as exchanged it for another.

Yet the alternative is rarely neutral. When cities do nothing, residents **bear the brunt**, through rising rents, vanishing shops, and neighborhoods **hollowed out** by short-term rentals. Doing nothing is itself a policy; its costs simply fall on people with less power to complain, and less chance of being heard.

The stronger case, then, is not that intervention is harmless but that its **trade-offs** can be managed. A modest tourist tax, spent visibly on housing and public services, asks visitors to contribute without shutting them out. Limits on short-term rentals protect the permanent population that gives a place its character in the first place.

The cure is worse than the disease only when it is badly designed or carelessly applied. Well-targeted rules will not fully **reconcile** residents and visitors, but they can stop a city from becoming **a victim of its own success**.